

OLLIE FRANCIS

Digital Product Designer and Mentor

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An experienced designer, facilitator, and mentor with over 25 years of experience helping individuals and teams navigate complex challenges. While my professional background is in design and technology, my core strength lies in understanding human needs, removing fear, and facilitating growth.

I founded UX design consultancy Deckchair. We work with teams to discover user needs and define business problems. I rapidly build prototypes to test with real users in days rather than weeks. I love to create a safe space for teams to thrive. I work with clients in social housing, music and science sectors – specialising in large scale digital tools that have members or large communities.

Core skills

- UX/UI Designer
- Digital Artist
- Workshop Facilitator
- Coach & Mentor

Interests

- Outdoors & nature
- Computers
- Games of all kinds
- Food & cooking
- Travel & adventures

Professional Experience

1998 – Present	Deckchair Founder, Consultant & Product Designer Co-founded a design consultancy helping organisations like the NHS, Dept of Health, and the UK Space Agency build better services for people.
2024 – Present	Open Format Product Designer & Mentor In-house product designer and mentor, working closely with a young team on Aartoo, an AI based product that helps build communities.
2021	CoTeam Mentor Working with the excellent teams at CoTeam and H&M, I mentored three brilliant new-in-role Product Designers for ten weeks.
2017 – 2019	Develop Me Course Instructor Teaching the key skills required to practice UX, enabling graduates to research, define, design and develop successful digital services

Life Experience

Mens circle leader	I hold circle around a fire outdoors each month, formed in 2024.
Poetry book creator	Crowd funding and design for Pen & Corrections, a book of poetry written by serving prisoners.
Charity volunteer	I have donated 100s of hours of design work and mentoring to various charities including Frank Water, Penny Bohn and The Pituitary Foundation.